

Hymn of Breaking Strain

*He went over it in his head, plate by plate, span by span, brick by brick, pier by pier,
remembering, comparing, estimating, and recalculating, lest there should be any mistake;
and through the long hours and through the flights of formulae that danced
and wheeled before him, a cold fear would come to pinch his heart...*

Text: Rudyard Kipling, 1935, alt.

Music: Leslie Fish, 1983

BREAKING STRAIN 76.76.76.76.6

arr. Kenan Schaeferkofer, 2021

1 The care-ful text-books mea-sure (Let all who build be-ware!)

2 But in our dai-ly deal-ing with stone and steel, we find

3 The pru-dent text-books give it in ta-bles at the end:

4 We on-ly of Cre-a-tion (Oh, luck-ier bridge and rail)

5 Oh, veil-ed, se-cret Pow-er, whose paths we seek in vain,

1 the load, the shock, the pres-sure ma-ter-i-al can bear.

2 the gods have no such feel-ing of guilt for hu-man-kind.

3 the stress that shears a riv-et, or makes a tie-bar bend,

4 a-bide the twin dam-na-tion: To fail and know we fail.

5 be with us in our hour— of ov-er-throw and pain;

1 So when a buck-led gir-der lets down a steel cas-cade,

2 To no set gauge they make us, for no laid course pre-pare,

3 what traf-fic wrecks mac-a-dam, what con-crete should en-dure.

4 Yet we—by which sole to-ken we know we once were gods—

5 that we—by which sure to-ken we know Thy ways are true—

1 the blame for loss, or mur-der is on the ma-ker laid.

2 and pres-ent-ly o'er-take us with loads we can-not bear:

3 But we, of Eve and A-dam have no such lit'-ra-ture,

4 take shame in be-ing bro-ken, how-ev-er great the odds.

5 be-cause of be-ing bro-ken, may rise and build a-new.

Oh_____ the ma - ker, not the made!
too mer - ci - less to bear.
Oh_____ to warn us or make sure!
the bur - den of the Odds.
stand up and build a - new.

The image shows a musical score for a hymn. It consists of two staves, a treble staff on top and a bass staff on the bottom, both in the key of D major (indicated by two sharps). The melody is written in the treble staff, and the bass line is in the bass staff. The lyrics are written below the staves, aligned with the notes. The lyrics are: "Oh_____ the ma - ker, not the made! too mer - ci - less to bear. Oh_____ to warn us or make sure! the bur - den of the Odds. stand up and build a - new." The score includes various musical notations such as notes, rests, and slurs.